

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Family arguments happen!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can express regret about unfulfilled action.
- I can talk about unreal past situations.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you have disagreements with your parents or siblings or spouse?
- What are the disagreements usually about?
- How are they solved?





Let's Explore!

The two brothers became **the worst of enemies***

* When you are "*the worst of enemies*" you hate each other.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Edward and Robert had never fought before, but as they sat going over their father's will in their lawyer's office, the two brothers became the worst of enemies. In his will, Thomas Harmer left the big old house on Cranberry Lane to both brothers to share. If only sharing had been something that the brothers had been willing to do.

If only Edward hadn't wanted to sell the house and split the money. If only Robert hadn't wanted, equally as much, to keep it. Robert said that if their father had wanted the house to have been sold, he would have said so. Edward said that their father had known the house to have been outdated and ready to sell. Edward felt that if Robert's clan were prepared to have taken it on and buy the other one out, that would be a possibility.

If neither was willing to have compromised, then each was convinced to have had more right to the house than the other. The result was that the house on Cranberry Lane stood empty. Both families wished that the two brothers, who had been inseparable as children, would speak to each other.

Edward was in his car when he heard the news. Robert saw it on television. A hurricane had struck the Florida Keys, very close to the town where they had grown up. It was the biggest and strongest hurricane to hit the coast in 200 years. Both wished they had known beforehand to close it up properly. If the reports were to have been believed, then the old place would have been in danger.

As soon as reports declared the storm was over, both brothers ran to their cars and headed for the airport. At virtually the same time, the two men boarded planes to Florida. Within minutes of each other, they reached the site of their childhood home.

Edward looked up at Robert and slowly walked towards him. Robert imagined that they were children again, in their garden. Except that now their garden was a pool of mud, filled with the wreckage of the storm. What did material things mean when they could be destroyed within minutes? What meaning did a family house have without a family? Without speaking, the two men embraced.





Let's Practice!

A hurricane hit the Harmers' residence*.

*A "residence" is the place where someone lives.

Instructions: Use the options from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. There are extra options you do not need to use.

Word Bank

had been inseparable / have known / had known beforehand / had been willing to do / has been / hadn't wanted to sell the / hadn't wanted

1. If only sharing had been something that the brothers _____.
2. If only Edward _____ house and split the money.
3. If only Robert _____, equally as much, to keep it.
4. Both families wished that the two brothers, who _____ as children, would speak to each other.
5. Both wished they _____ to close it up properly.



Let's Practice!

The brothers are finally reunited* again.

*To be "reunited" means to come together after a long period of time.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistake. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Robert said that if their father had wanted the house to being selling he would have said so.
2. Edward said that their father had known the house to has being outdates and ready to sell.
3. Edward felt that if Robert's clan had been prepared to has taking it on and buy the other one out, that would be a possibility.
4. If either had wanted to has compromising , then each would have said they had more right to the house than the other.
5. If the news had reported to has seeing widespread damage then the old place would have been in danger.





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue between family members disagreeing.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Read the text on page 2 again.
- Imagine that you hear the argument between Edward and Robert.
- Write a dialogue between them.
- In your dialogue, use words for character traits.
- Express regret and unfulfilled action.
- Write about 200 words.
- Read your dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue between Robert and Edward.

☐ ☐

I use adjectives for character traits.

☐ ☐

I use the Simple Past and the Past Perfect.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **will** (noun): official statement of what should be done with money and property after a death
e.g. As they sat going over their father's will in the lawyer's office, the two brothers became the worst of enemies.
- **to split** (verb): to divide into two or more parts
e.g. If only Edward hadn't wanted to sell the house and split the money.
- **clan** (noun): family
e.g. Edward felt that if Robert's clan were prepared to have taken it on and buy the other one out, that would be a possibility.
- **to compromise** (verb): to come to an agreement in which each side has given up something it had wanted
e.g. If neither was willing to have compromised, then each was convinced to have had more right to the house than the other.
- **hurricane** (noun): a violent storm with strong circular winds
e.g. A hurricane had struck the Florida Keys.
- **material things** (noun): physical objects
e.g. What did material things mean when they could be destroyed within minutes?
- **to embrace** (verb): to hold someone close to you with your arms
e.g. Without speaking, the two men embraced.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect Tense to Show Regret

The Past Perfect doesn't only refer to an action prior to a past event. You can also use it to express regret. When you want to talk about something that you did or did not do and that has a negative effect on the present, use the Past Perfect.

The form of the Past Perfect is:

subject + *had* + past participle

You can use the structure *If only/I wish* + Past Perfect to express regret.

For example:

If only ***I had talked*** to him then, *I would know how he feels.*

I wish ***I had woken*** up earlier - *I wouldn't have been late for work.*

Examples:

- *If only sharing had been something that the brothers had been willing to do.*
- *If only Edward hadn't wanted to sell the house and split the money.*
- *If only Robert hadn't wanted, equally as much, to keep it.*
- *Both families wished that the two brothers, who had been inseparable as children, would speak to each other.*
- *Both wished they had known beforehand to close it up properly.*





Learning Points

Perfect Infinitives in Third Conditional

You use the third conditional to describe an unreal situation with reference to the past. You imagine a hypothetical situation, something that did not happen. You use the Perfect infinitive in the result clause of the third conditional.

The structure of the third conditional is:

If + past perfect + perfect infinitive

For example:

*If the driver **had thought to have fastened** his seatbelt, he probably would have survived the accident.*

*If we **had decided to have booked** our flight earlier, it would have been cheaper.*

Examples:

- *Robert said that if their father had wanted the house to have been sold he would have said so.*
- *Edward said that their father had known the house to have been outdated and ready to sell.*
- *Edward felt that if Robert's clan had been prepared to have taken it on and buy the other one out, that would be a possibility.*
- *If either had wanted to have compromised, then each would have said they had more right to the house than the other.*
- *If the news had reported to have seen widespread damage, then the old place would have been in danger.*

